

Career Counsellors Pune

Right Direction

To guide students on entrance exams

Ketan Deshpande enjoys bucking convention. The 22-year-old student from Pune's Vishwakarma Institute of Technology has established the Friends Union for Energising Lives (FUEL) to help the confused and the challenged choose from the choices available in Maharashtra. Now a regular in travelling to various cities to brief parents and students on how and where to apply for entrance tests, Deshpande started out by compiling information from 110 state institutes in a book, *Student's Fuel*. He now has an online software as well. FUEL didn't start out as a random idea. Deshpande had missed appearing for the AIEEE which he thinks he could have cleared had it not been for an error in writing the demand draft. He then took more than 30 examinations to get first-hand information on the selection procedure, so that no other student would miss an opportunity due to such

glitches. He says he was most touched when a junior he had helped get admission in his college immediately became part of FUEL. While voluntary donations were used to finance FUEL initially, money generated from the sale of the book has helped them expand their activities. But when Deshpande is not busy with FUEL or studies, he's like any other college boy, excited when his dreams come true. As he was when he was invited to meet former president APJ Abdul Kalam. "Kalam told me that if a dead man's bier can get the support of four men, why can't such an initiative for the young get backed by many more?" says Deshpande.

by Mitali Patel

"I don't want anyone to be denied admission into a college because of technical glitches."

KETAN DESHPANDE

Founder, FUEL

DESHPANDE (SECOND FROM LEFT) WITH FUEL VOLUNTEERS (L TO R) ANKIT KABRA (21), SAGAR LADDHA (24) AND NAVAL SHINDE (22)



JOHN PAUL (EXTREME LEFT) WITH CSC VOLUNTEERS

e-Service Providers
Jammu and Kashmir

First Serve

DREAM
To promote brand Kashmir

They dreamt of setting up an e-bay for brand Kashmir. And it may well have remained in the realm of fantasy if Kashif Khan, 24, and Rayees Rasool, 25, had given up. Having developed a plan to e-manage a range of community services in Kashmir, their first project was to train students at the Islamic University of Science and Technology in integrated chip design. When they went looking for trainers in big cities, nobody wanted to come to the valley of uncertainty. That didn't stop Khan from undergoing a 15-day course, coming back and training nearly 70 students